

Skills Summary

Position Words for Shapes

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Count the shapes in one place

Rule: First find the PLACE the question names (top shelf, bottom row, between two shapes). Then count only the shapes in that place — nothing outside it.

Example: 5 shapes stand in a row. How many shapes are BETWEEN the first one and the last one?

Step 1. “Between” leaves out the two end shapes — so count the row, then take the two ends away.

Step 2. $5 - 2 = 3$.

⇒ 3 shapes are between the ends

Try it: 6 shapes stand in a row. How many are between the first and the last?

check: 4

Name the shape at a position

Rule: Position words point at ONE spot: below means straight down, next to means touching distance, right and left follow YOUR hands. Find the spot first, then name the shape by its sides and corners.

Example: The shape below the circle has 6 straight sides. How many corners does it have — and what is it?

Step 1. Find the spot (straight down from the circle), then use the side count: sides and corners always match.

Step 2. 6 sides means 6 corners — that shape is a hexagon.

⇒ it has 6 corners: a hexagon

Try it: The shape to the right of the door has 3 straight sides. How many corners does it have, and what is it?

check: 3 corners — a triangle

Use position words yourself

Rule: A good “where” sentence names the shape, a position word, and a neighbor: “The star is ABOVE the box.” Two position words make the spot even clearer.

Example: The ball sits under the table. Finish: “The ball is _____ the table.”

Step 1. Ask: where is the ball when you look from the table? It is lower — straight down.

Step 2. Lower and straight down is the word BELOW (or under).

The sentence reads: the ball is **below** the table.

Try it: The lamp sits higher than the shelf, straight up. Finish: “The lamp is _____ the shelf.”

(check: above or over)

(!) Watch out: Left and right swap when a friend faces you! On paper, use YOUR left hand and right hand — the page always faces the same way.